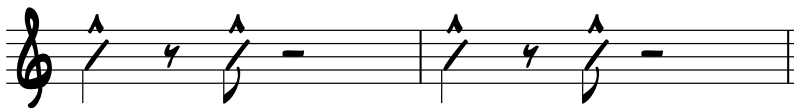


COMPING (& HORN BACKGROUNDS) PART 1

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #61

The most important roll of pianists and guitar players in the jazz band is to "comp" (for themselves, and for the other musicians). To play the chords, to accompany. And, if you have more than two horns (or singers) in the group, those folks should be learning about comping as well - coming up with horn or vocal backgrounds. Most importantly, comping is about RHYTHM.

#1 - The Charleston Rhythm



One of the most important rhythms in almost any style of jazz.

#2



The Charleston Rhythm, displaced by one 8th note later (beginning on the "+" of 1."

#3



The Charleston Rhythm, displaced by two 8th notes later (beginning on "beat 2."

#4



The Charleston Rhythm, displaced by three 8th notes later (beginning on the "+" of 2."

#5



The Charleston Rhythm, displaced by four 8th notes, later (beginning on "beat 3."

Then, an amazing thing happens when we begin to change our articulation, the "longs and shorts." Here, we played "short - short." Try playing these rhythms "long - short" or "short - long." It is amazing the hundreds of great rhythmic patterns we can come up with (and that our heroes regularly used) with just this one rhythm as our "seed." 90% of ALL comping begins here.